

Ancient Greek Text Classification with BERT & Neural Networks

This project implements deep learning models to classify Ancient Greek inscriptions based on their textual content and metadata. The system leverages **BERT** (Bidirectional Encoder Representations from Transformers) for text tokenization and **PyTorch neural networks** for classification, achieving high accuracy in predicting regional origins and date ranges of ancient texts.

Dataset

The model uses the **IPhi2802** dataset containing Ancient Greek inscriptions with the following features:

Column	Description
text	The inscription text in Ancient Greek
region_main	Primary region of origin
region_sub	Sub-region of origin
date_min	Minimum estimated date
date_max	Maximum estimated date
metadata, id, date_str, date_circa	Additional metadata (dropped)

Project Structure

```
├── Models/
│   ├── __init__.py
│   ├── Errors.py           # Custom exception classes
│   └── PyTorch_NN.py       # PyTorch neural network implementation
├── with cross-validation
│   ├── FileManagement.py   # File I/O operations (CSV, JSON, exports)
│   └── Models/DataManagement.py # Data preprocessing and cleaning utilities
├── BertModel.ipynb         # BERT tokenization and model training notebook
├── main.ipynb              # Main training notebook with TF-IDF vectorization
├── requirements.txt        # Python dependencies
├── exports/                # Training logs and results
│   ├── images/            # Training/validation loss plots
│   └── *.txt              # Per-fold training metrics
├── data/                   # Dataset directory (not included)
│   ├── iphi2802.csv       # Main dataset
│   └── greek_stopwords.json # Greek stop words list
```

Preprocessing Pipeline

The data undergoes several cleaning steps:

1. **Column removal** - Drop non-informative columns (`metadata`, `id`, `region_main`, `region_sub`, `date_str`, `date_circa`)
2. **Text cleaning**:
 - Remove whitespace and special characters (`[]`, `-`, `.`)
 - Convert to lowercase
 - Remove single-character words
 - Remove Greek stop words
 - Filter out words with frequency < 5
3. **Empty cell handling** - Remove rows with empty text after cleaning

Feature Extraction

Two text vectorization methods are implemented:

TF-IDF Vectorization (`main.ipynb`)

- Converts text to TF-IDF feature matrix
- Combined with metadata features (`region_main_id`, `region_sub_id`, `date_min`, `date_max`)

BERT Tokenization (`BertModel.ipynb`)

- Uses `pranaydeeps/Ancient-Greek-BERT` pretrained model
- Tokenizes text with maximum length of 4469 tokens
- Combines token embeddings with metadata features

Model Architecture

The project implements several neural network architectures using PyTorch:

Base Model

```
Input (1899 features) → Dense(3560) → ReLU → Dense(2) → Sigmoid
```

Multi-layer Model

```
Input → Dense(3560) → ReLU → Dense(1780) → ReLU → Dense(2) → Sigmoid
```

Multi-layer with Dropout

```
Input → Dropout(R_IN) → Dense(3560) → ReLU → Dropout(R_H) →  
Dense(1780) → ReLU → Dropout(R_H) → Dense(2) → Sigmoid
```

Hyperparameter Configurations

- **Input nodes:** 1899 (after TF-IDF)
- **Hidden layer nodes:** 3560 (formula: $2 * \text{INPUT_NODES} - \text{INPUT_NODES}/8$)
- **Output nodes:** 2 (binary classification)
- **Epochs:** 200
- **Batch size:** 16
- **Learning rate:** 0.001 - 0.1 (tested)
- **Momentum:** 0.2 - 0.6 (tested)
- **Dropout rates:** R_IN = 0.5/0.8, R_H = 0.2/0.5
- **Optimizer:** Adam / SGD
- **Loss function:** MSELoss (for date regression) / CrossEntropyLoss (for classification)

Training Methodology

- **Cross-validation:** 5-fold K-Fold with shuffling
- **Early stopping:** Configurable patience (default: 5 epochs)
- **Device support:** Automatically uses CUDA (NVIDIA), MPS (Apple Silicon), or CPU
- **Metrics tracked per fold:**
 - Validation Loss
 - RMSE (Root Mean Square Error)

Results

Best Performing Configuration

Multi-layer Perceptron with SGD optimizer

- Learning rate: 0.001
- Momentum: 0.2
- Hidden nodes: 3560
- **Final RMSE: 0.03786**

Comparative Results

Configuration	Learning Rate	Momentum	Dropout	Validation Loss	RMSE
MLP (SGD)	0.001	0.2	None	0.00143	0.03786
MLP (Adam)	0.001	0.2	None	0.00207	0.04551
MLP (SGD)	0.001	0.6	None	0.00162	0.05334
MLP w/ Dropout	0.001	0.2	R_IN=0.5, R_H=0.5	0.00712	0.08436
MLP (SGD)	0.05	0.6	None	0.13363	0.36599
MLP (SGD)	0.1	0.6	None	0.13640	0.38386

Hidden Layer Size Comparison (200 epochs, batch=16)

Hidden Nodes	Formula	RMSE
633	$(\text{INPUT} + \text{OUTPUT})/3$	0.14867
1268	$(\text{INPUT} * 2/3) + \text{OUTPUT}$	0.10822
3560	$2 * \text{INPUT} - \text{INPUT}/8$	0.08954

Key Findings

1. **Lower learning rate (0.001) significantly outperforms higher rates**
2. **SGD with momentum 0.2 outperforms SGD with momentum 0.6**
3. **Larger hidden layer (3560) yields best results**
4. **Dropout may not be beneficial for this dataset** (RMSE increased from 0.03786 to 0.08436)
5. **Adam performs comparably but slightly worse than SGD** (0.04551 vs 0.03786)

Usage

Installation

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

Download NLTK Data (for tokenization)

```
import nltk
nltk.download('punkt')
```

Run TF-IDF Model

```
jupyter notebook main.ipynb
```

Run BERT Model

```
jupyter notebook BertModel.ipynb
```

Custom Training Configuration

```
from Models import PyTorch_NN
```

```
model = PyTorch_NN.PyTorchModel(  
    hidden_layer_nodes=3560,  
    epochs=200,  
    batch_size=16,  
    X=X, y=y,  
    momentum=0.2,  
    learning_rate=0.001  
)  
model.create_default_model()  
model.train_test(with_early_stopping=False)
```

Custom Loss Function

The project includes a custom **BoundaryDeviationLoss** class that penalizes predictions falling outside the target range (useful for date prediction tasks where the true value lies between `date_min` and `date_max`).

Output Files

Training results are automatically exported to `exports/` directory:

- `{epochs}_{batch_size}_{hidden_nodes}_{lr}_{momentum}.txt` - Per-fold metrics
- `foo.png` - Training/validation loss curves

Dependencies

- Python 3.10+
- PyTorch 2.2.0
- scikit-learn 1.4.2
- pandas 2.2.2
- numpy 1.26.4
- matplotlib 3.8.4
- nltk 3.8.1
- transformers (for BERT model)

Notes

- The dataset file `iphi2802.csv` must be placed in the `data/` directory
- Greek stop words should be in `data/greek_stopwords.json`
- For BERT model, the Ancient-Greek-BERT model is downloaded automatically via HuggingFace
- Decimal values in the dataset are handled automatically
- The project automatically detects and uses GPU acceleration if available

License

This project is for educational and research purposes. The IPhi2802 dataset and Ancient-Greek-BERT model have their own usage terms - please cite appropriately.

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